Family 2.0

By Walter Wykes

INTRODUCTION

How many times have we heard the cliche, "The grass is always greener on the other side?" While the overuse of this phrase has mostly dulled its impact, people who experience the "grass is greener syndrome" endure a significant struggle. They truly believe that there is always something better what they have. Whether it's with relationships, careers, where they live, or their family, they always have one foot out the door.

Absurd? You have no idea! Meet Family 2.0 by Walter Wykes.

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A perfect-looking house-the kind you find in magazines. A perfect-looking wife puts the finishing touches on her perfect-looking living room. The front door opens and husband enters.

HUSBAND: Hi, Honey! I'm home!

WIFE: Who are you? What are you doing in my house?!

HUSBAND: I'm your new husband. Where should I put my coat? *[He tries to kiss wife; but she backs away from him terrified.]*

WIFE: Don't touch me! I'll scream! I'll call the police!

HUSBAND: Aren't you going to ask how my day was?

WIFE: *[Attempting to pacify him]* How ... how was your day?

HUSBAND: It was awful! Just like every other day! Same old boring job. Same old boring boss. Same old boring *life.* And then, on the way home, suddenly it hit to me -- why come home to the same old boring wife and house and kids and dog when I could try something new?

WIFE: But you can't just-

HUSBAND: I've always admired your home. It's very well kept.

WIFE: Thank you, but-

HUSBAND: I pass it every day on my way to work, so I thought today I'd give it a try. It has

to be more exciting than the one I've been coming home to for the past fifteen years.

WIFE: But ... I already have a husband.

HUSBAND: He can have my life. Where does he work?

WIFE: He's an executive. At a technology company.

HUSBAND: Perfect! I love technology! All those little gadgets and stuff! It'll be great!

WIFE: Look, I'm ... I'm sorry your life is so boring. My life is boring too. But you can't just walk in here and expect us to-

HUSBAND: Oh! I almost forgot! I brought you flowers! *[He produces a bouquet of flowers from his coat.}*

WIFE: You brought me flowers?

HUSBAND: They're orchids-a symbol of rare beauty and eternal love-my love for you.

WIFE: My ... my husband hasn't brought me flowers in almost fifteen years.

HUSBAND: I wrote you a poem too.

WIFE: A poem?

HUSBAND: Would you like me to recite it?

WIFE: Well ... if you went to the trouble of writing it ... I ... I wouldn't want it to go to waste.

HUSBAND: You take my breath away. / Like the sunset or a summer day. / When I gaze at the moon / Or the ocean blue / They pale beside the sight of you. / You take my breath away.

WIFE: That's beautiful. You ... you really wrote that?

HUSBAND: For you. *[Pause. She considers this.]*

WIFE: Do you pee in the shower?

HUSBAND: Never.

WIFE: Hog the sheets?

HUSBAND: Nope.

WIFE: Snore?

HUSBAND: I don't think so.

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WIFE: Any history of baldness in your family?

HUSBAND: On the contrary. We're very hairy.

WIFE: Would you do your own laundry or wait for me to do it.

HUSBAND: Do it myself.

WIFE: Fix the toilet or call a plumber?

HUSBAND: Fix it.

WIFE: Shingle the roof or buy a new house?

HUSBAND: New house.

WIFE: Anniversary in Maui or Vegas?

HUSBAND: Maui.

WIFE: You'll have to win the kids over first. Children! *[Enter SON and DAUGHTER]* Children, meet your new father.

HUSBAND: Hi, kids.

SON: You're not my father! You're a fake! An imposter!

HUSBAND: Do you like baseball? I'll take you to the Big Game.

SON: The Big Game?! No way! *[He embraces husband] I* love you, Dad!

DAUGHTER: What about me? I hate baseball.

HUSBAND: Do you like shopping? Here-knock yourself out. *[He hands her a hundred-dollar bill.]*

DAUGHTER: A hundred-dollar bill?! You're the greatest! *[She kisses him on the cheek.}*

WIFE: Go play in your room, kids. Your father and I need some time alone.

DAUGHTER: Sure thing, Mom.

SON: See ya later, Dad. *[Exit kids.]*

WIFE: *[Seductively.]* Now where were we? *[They kiss passionately. Enter FIRST HUSBAND]*

FIRST HUSBAND: [Entering] Hi, Honey! I'm ... what's going on here?! What are you doing to my wife?! I'm calling the police!

WIFE: Wait! Give me your key.

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FIRST HUSBAND: What?

WIFE: Your key. Hand it over.

FIRST HUSBAND: I don't understand.

WIFE: He's replacing you.

FIRST HUSBAND: *Replacing me?*

WIFE: That's right. He's in-you're out.

FIRST HUSBAND: But why?!

WIFE: He brought me flowers! When's the last time you brought me flowers?!

FIRST HUSBAND: *(Stammers)* I . . . I . . . I. . .

WIFE: Exactly. Now stop stuttering and hand over the key.

FIRST HUSBAND: But ... what about the kids?! You can't take the kids away from me! Kids! *[Enter SON and DAUGHTER]* You don't want me to go-do you kids?

SON: He's taking me to the Big Game.

FIRST HUSBAND: I'll take you!

SON: Too late. You had your chance.

DAUGHTER: Sorry. It's nothing personal.

WIFE: *[Her hand outstretched.]* The key.

FIRST HUSBAND: But I don't want to go! Please, I'll ... I'll do anything! Just let me stay! I won't bother you! I'll stay out of the way! I'll ... I'll be another kid! Or the family dog! [He assumes the character of a dog, wags his tail, barks]

SON: I've always wanted a dog! Please?! Can I keep him?! Can I?!

WIFE: I don't know. What do you think, Honey?

HUSBAND: He'd be your responsibility, son. We're not going to feed him for you, or take him for walks, or clean up his poop-

SON: I'll take care of him! I promise! *[To DOG]* Come here, boy! Sit! Roll over! Play dead! Good boy! *[Dog follows all commands barking excessively]*

DAUGHTER: Can I go shopping now? *(She is ignored)*

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FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof! Woof!

WIFE: I think the dog has to go.

HUSBAND: Son, take your dog outside.

SON: I can't. I have homework. *[Exit son]*

DAUGHTER: Can I go shopping or not? *(she is ignored again)*

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof! Woof!

WIFE: Honey, could you take care of the dog? *(reproachfully)* You told him he could keep it.

HUSBAND: Do we have a leash?

DAUGHTER: Is anybody listening to me? *[Enter son with baseball and glove.]*

SON: Hey Dad, can we play ball?

HUSBAND: I thought you had homework.

SON: I just finished.

HUSBAND: *[To son]* Here-take the dog outside.

SON: I have to poop. *[Exit son]*

DAUGHTER: *Hello?* I hate this family!

WIFE: *[To husband}* While you're out, can you take the trash? And could you do something about your daughter?

HUSBAND: What do you want me to-

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof! Woof!

HUSBAND: *[To Dog]* Shut up, you stupid mutt! *(Dog continues barking and spinning in circles)*

WIFE: I think he really wants to go.

DAUGHTER: What about me?! Does anybody care what I want?! *[Enter son}*

SON: The Big Game starts any minute! We have to go!

HUSBAND: *[To wife]* When ... when we get back it would be really nice to have some quality *alone time* if you know what I mean.

WIFE: It'll have to wait, Dear. You have responsibilities now.

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HUSBAND: Responsibilities?! This isn't what I signed up for! You're just like my first wife!

WIFE: *WHAT* did you say?!!!

SON: We're gonna miss the game! We have to go NOW! You promised!

DAUGHTER: I asked first! It's not fair! You can't just ignore me!

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof!

As the cacophony rises, everyone converges on HUSBAN.D They surround him like a pack of rabid wolves.

WIFE: Are you hearing me?! Are we clear on this?! It's gonna take a LOT to make up for this little slip-up, Mister!

SON: All I wanted to do was go to the Big Game! But now it's too late! I already told all of my friends we were going, and they're all going to know what losers we are!

DAUGHTER: Am I invisible? Am I not even here? What do I have to do to get some attention in this house?!

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof! Woof!

HUSBAND: I NEED A NEW LIFE!!!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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